

Chris Smith

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SUMMARY

Learning Technology and Communications Specialist with over five years of progressive experience in higher education, supporting the implementation and management of Learning Management Systems (LMS) such as D2L/Brightspace. Skilled in planning, designing, and delivering institutional learning content, courses, and training programs for diverse academic audiences. Experienced in developing and integrating applied educational projects, facilitating digital learning environments, supporting technology upgrades, and resolving technical challenges through collaboration with IT and academic teams. Strong communicator with a track record of supporting strategic learning initiatives and fostering student-centered, innovative, and applied learning. Bilingual in English and experienced working in multicultural, international settings.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Instructional Designer (contract) | Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Boston, MA

August 2025 - October 2025

Led rapid learning and curriculum design initiatives focused on improving engagement and operational efficiency within a short-term contract. Collaborated with stakeholders to align training with organizational objectives and improve learner experience using innovative technologies.

- Led rapid instructional design and online curriculum development projects, aligning training materials and course content with institutional learning objectives and applied education models.
- Facilitated cross-functional collaboration to integrate innovative technologies into online and hybrid learning environments, improving student engagement and training effectiveness.
- Developed and disseminated accessible communication and training resources for faculty and students to support smooth adoption of new e-learning systems and tools.
- Conducted needs analysis, gathered feedback, and leveraged digital analytics to inform continuous improvement of projects and instructional resources.

Educational Technology Specialist (contract) | Carleton University, Ottawa, ON, CA

August 2021 - September 2022

- Administered and maintained Learning Management Systems (LMS) for 5,000+ users, supporting course creation, section setup, enrollment, and lab environment integration across multiple departments.
- Delivered training and support for faculty, staff, and students on D2L/Brightspace and other digital learning tools, increasing effective system usage and minimizing disruptions during platform upgrades.
- Developed and updated training materials, user documentation, and digital content in alignment with applied learning principles and accessibility standards (AODA, SCORM).
- Collaborated with IT and academic teams to troubleshoot, resolve, and escalate advanced LMS and educational technology issues; tracked and reported on incident resolution to leadership.
- Supported strategic institutional initiatives aimed at enhancing digital learning and applied education, working closely with management to meet organizational goals.

Communications and Marketing Officer (contract) | Harvard University, Boston, MA, USA

August 2025 - October 2025

Delivered targeted digital communications to support institutional branding and stakeholder engagement, within a focused contract period. Developed and executed campaigns leveraging analytics to optimize outreach impact

- Produced press releases, talking points, and media announcements to promote institutional campaigns and academic research.
- Managed stakeholder outreach and cross-team collaboration for local and national media coverage.
- Supported executive messaging, coordinated with PR agencies, and delivered impactful content for print, digital, and broadcast channels.
- Facilitated crisis response communications and contributed to rapid media engagement in high-stakes settings.

Digital Content and Communications Specialist (contract) | Carleton University, Ottawa, ON, CA

March 2025 - August 2025

Coordinated comprehensive digital engagement campaigns fostering inclusivity and diversity across campus populations. Created reports and collaborated with departments to enhance communication effectiveness.

- Led digital engagement campaigns, media outreach, and cross-department messaging for student and university events.
- Drafted and edited reports, publications, and internal communications materials for diverse audiences.
- Coordinated with graphic designers to produce multimedia collateral and promotional materials.
- Developed dashboards to analyze campaign reach, effectiveness, and media metrics; recommended improvements to communications strategies.
- Collaborated with Facilities & Operations to optimize event logistics, safety procedures, and ongoing maintenance needs.
- Ensured proper risk management and safety compliance during all events and bookings.

CuPortfolio & IT Development Coordinator (contract) | Carleton University, Ottawa, ON, CA

September 2023 - October 2024

- Managed learning technologies and user access for thousands of students and faculty, supporting integration with institutional learning initiatives and digital transformation projects.
- Delivered group and individual training on new systems features, best practices, and digital collaboration tools.
- Worked with departments to ensure ongoing compliance and inclusion in platform access and content.

Sprott Employability Passport Coordinator (contract) | Carleton University, Ottawa, ON, CA

October 2024 - March 2025

- Coordinated LMS dashboard management, tracking skills growth, career readiness, and ensuring optimal outcomes from applied learning activities and workshops.
- Maintained content/digital platform compliance with institutional, privacy, and accessibility priorities.

Engagement Strategy Advisor (contract) | Carleton University, Ottawa, ON, CA

September 2022 - September 2023

- Led multi-channel communications to enhance alumni engagement and fundraising impact, including media relations and event coverage.
- Built relationships with volunteers, advancement staff, and external partners for audience development.
- Drafted appeals, newsletters, and case-for-support content for print and digital campaigns.

Professor, Sports Management | Georgian College, Barrie, ON, CA

September 2018 - April 2024

- Developed and delivered curriculum for sports management, recreation programming, and leadership courses, emphasizing experiential and inclusive approaches.
- Led capstone projects and case studies focused on real-world sports event planning, risk management, and student engagement.
- Mentored and assessed diverse groups of students, supporting professional growth and teamwork.
- Developed and maintained digital scheduling systems for efficient space reservations, supporting both college and community partners.

Associate Producer, Story Editor, Writer | The Sports Network (TSN), Toronto, ON, CA

December 2010 - August 2021

- Produced and coordinated content for national sports broadcasts, major events, and live coverage, collaborating with large teams to deliver consistent, timely results.
- Led editorial planning, story assignment, and crisis coverage, ensuring high-quality, accurate information under pressure.
- Managed relationships with athletes, coaches, and community partners to promote sports culture and inclusion.

Lifelong Learning Lecturer | Carleton University, Ottawa, ON, CA

January 2024 - May 2025

- Delivered engaging adult learner workshops focused on digital marketing, user experience, and data analytics.
- Applied learner-centered assessment techniques supporting learner success and program outcomes.
- Coordinated workshop content with institutional objectives and stakeholder requirements.

PROJECTS

Engineering Iron Ring & Graduation Digital Campaign (2025) | Carleton University

www.instagram.com/carleton_engdesign/?hl=en, March 2025 - June 2025

- Engineered interactive digital campaigns driving 40% student engagement and 25% campaign awareness increases.

"Hard to Study When You're Hungry" Campaign (Carleton Food Bank, 2023) | Carleton University

vimeo.com/818420627?share=copy, April 2023 - May 2023

- Developed multi-channel content that increased awareness by 25%, using targeted social media and email marketing strategies.

Efficiency Improvements in Sprott (2024)

October 2024 - March 2025

- Automated reporting workflows integrating EDI and authentic learning theory aligned with institutional priorities

Co-op/Career Website Migration & UX Redesign (2023) | Carleton University

April 2024 - August 2024

- Led website UX redesign improving accessibility and usability by 15%, aligned with inclusivity and conversion goals.

EDUCATION

Master of Education, Teaching and Learning | University of Ottawa

Ottawa, 2020

Certificate, Business Communications | Toronto Metropolitan University

Toronto, 2016

Bachelor of Arts, Mass Communication | Carleton University

Ottawa, 2010

SKILLS

- Strategic planning, project, and event management
- Budget and risk management
- Staff recruitment, training, and mentorship
- Cross-functional leadership and stakeholder engagement
- Student and community engagement
- Verbal/written communication, media relations
- Facility and operations coordination
- Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, Adobe Creative Cloud
- Space/booking management software
- Launched new campus-wide recreation programming, increasing student engagement by 30% and improving satisfaction scores.
- Led the risk management review that updated standard event safety procedures and reduced incident rates.
- Designed digital workflows for scheduling and reports, improving planning efficiency for events and facilities.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Chair - Communications Committee | Carleton University | CUPE2424

September 2022 - Present

Volunteer Consultant - Racial Justice Committee | Carleton University | CUPE2424

September 2022 - Present

Volunteer Public Relations Coordinator | Special Olympics Durham | Special Olympics Ontario

October 2013 - October 2019

- Collaborated with coaching staff, athletes, and volunteers to plan, promote, and deliver inclusive community events and competitions.
- Led communications and public engagement, maximizing participant satisfaction and community awareness.
- Fostered relationships with sponsors, media, and civic stakeholders to expand athlete opportunities.